

MERCY CHERONO

Data Analyst · Business Analyst · Risk & Underwriting Analyst

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Data analyst with an MSc in Data Science (Distinction, AIMS Rwanda) and a First Class BSc in Actuarial Science. I combine actuarial rigour with hands-on data science, cleaning and modelling data, building dashboards and pipelines, and communicating findings clearly to non-technical stakeholders. My background spans insurance, banking-adjacent financial services, wholesale, and development-sector settings, giving me a wide view of how data quality and clear reporting support real decisions, whether that's an underwriting call, a credit or risk decision, a retention strategy, or a partner report for an NGO. Open to remote and on-site roles as a Data Analyst, Business Analyst, Data Scientist, or Underwriting/Risk Analyst.

EXPERIENCE

Data Science & Analytics Intern

Mar 2026 – Present

Future Interns · Remote

- Built a customer churn classifier in Scikit-learn achieving 80–85% accuracy, then wrote it up as a business report with concrete retention recommendations, not just model metrics.
- Designed KPI dashboards in Python and Excel tracking revenue, profit margin, and regional sales growth, built to be readable by non-technical stakeholders.
- Managed three concurrent projects, sales analysis, churn prediction, and marketing funnel analysis, each with its own dataset, deadline, and deliverable format.

Business Processing & Compliance Assistant

Mar 2024 – Dec 2025

Britam Insurance · Nairobi, Kenya (Hybrid)

- Managed data quality across 100+ policy and member records monthly, cleaning, validating, and reconciling financial and membership data before it reached management reporting.
- Submitted operational and compliance reports to management and regulators on strict SLA timelines, without missing a deadline across 21 months.
- Coordinated data workflows across underwriting, finance, and client services teams.

Data Analytics & Programming Intern

Oct – Dec 2023

Mega Wholesalers · Remote

- Wrote Python scripts and SQL queries automating data cleaning and transformation workflows, cutting manual processing time by roughly 80%.
- Analysed sales and operations data to flag inefficiencies in logistics and procurement; findings fed directly into management planning.

Medical Underwriter → Intern

Aug 2021 – Aug 2022

Minet Kenya · Nairobi, Kenya

- Priced and processed medical insurance policies using actuarial judgement, then reconciled financials and validated membership data across a large client portfolio.
- Managed policy issuance, renewals, and membership data validation.

PROJECTS

Full write-ups, live demos, and code for all projects are on my portfolio: mcherono.github.io

- CRM Data Migration & Partner Import Tool; audited and migrated 32 partner records for an NGO's CRM, identifying 15 data quality issues, then built a deployed Next.js import tool.
- Claims Risk Scoring Model; Random Forest model flagging high-risk insurance claims for review, ROC-AUC 0.865.
- COVID-19 Data Pipeline & Dashboard; automated pipeline on a 209-country dataset, cutting manual processing time by roughly 80%.
- Customer Churn Prediction & Segmentation; classification model predicting churn at 80–85% accuracy, delivered as a retention strategy document.

EDUCATION

MSc Mathematical Sciences; Data Science

African Institute for Mathematical Sciences (AIMS) · Kigali, Rwanda

Aug 2022 - Jun 2023

Distinction

BSc Actuarial Science

Aug 2017 – Dec 2021

SKILLS

Languages & analysis: Python, pandas, NumPy, R, SQL, Julia, Bash

Visualisation & BI: Power BI, Excel (advanced), matplotlib, seaborn, ggplot2, Google Sheets

Machine learning & stats: scikit-learn, classification, regression, time series, non-parametric methods, statistical modelling

Automation & engineering: Pipeline automation, ETL, openpyxl, Google Colab, Linux, Next.js/React

Domain knowledge: Insurance analytics, actuarial science, risk analysis, financial modelling, underwriting, CRM & stakeholder data

Tools & platforms: Git, Jupyter, VS Code, DBeaver, RStudio, LaTeX, Monday.com, Vercel

Languages spoken: English (fluent), Kiswahili (fluent), Kalenjin (fluent)